Ira Akbar

Product Designer

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Product designer with 5+ years of experience taking complex digital products from discovery to launch. At Hunar.ai, I lead product and design for AI-powered hiring and outreach products, turning recruiter and candidate needs into self-serve tools and automated workflows. I work across research, interaction design, design systems and AI-assisted implementation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer | Hunar.ai

Bengaluru | March 2024 - Present | Series A

- Owned the roadmap and end-to-end design for Hunar Voice, leading designers and partnering closely with engineering as monthly calls grew from 3.1M to 11M (Mar-Sep 2026).
- Took Hunar Voice from an API-only tool to a self-serve platform spanning agent creation, campaign management, billing, self sign-up and multi-org workspaces. Cut time to a client's first campaign from months to a few days.
- Defined Hunar Connect's hiring workflows for AI assessments, CV matching, candidate recommendations and walk-in interviews. Extended Material Design for the CRM interface, used by 30+ active clients.
- Built Hunar's design system and visual identity from scratch across Voice and Connect, supporting complex recruitment and campaign workflows.
- Designed and shipped multi-stage outreach workflows for Zepto and Aditya Birla Capital using Claude Code, GCP and n8n. Win-back flows converted 3% of leads previously marked not engaged.
- Shaped adaptive multilingual conversations through contextual probing and branching. Used real call reviews to identify friction and reduce hallucinations and mid-call drop-offs.
- Built internal prompt-making tools with Claude and ChatGPT, cutting agent prompt preparation from 1-2 days to a few hours. The approach now informs an in-product context layer and prompt rewriter in development.
- Designed and validated Hunar Disha, a career assistant, through a concierge MVP with 40 pilot users and 8 candidates placed. Built and shipped a CV tailoring tool with Lovable and ChatGPT before the project was paused.

Consultant UX Designer | Kotak Securities

Mumbai (Remote) | September 2023 - February 2024

- Initiated Kotak Neo's first AI feature, a chat-based investing assistant. Defined the concept and designed the proof of concept that informed its beta launch.
- Used scroll and click data to identify overlooked features on StockCase and SipIt; restructured information hierarchy and A/B tested copy to improve discovery.

Product & Design | Quash

Bengaluru | June 2023 - January 2024 | Founding Team - Independent collaboration

- Designed the SDK integration experience and dashboard for a mobile app testing platform, taking it from concept to beta with a seven-member team.
- Led product discovery and translated customer feedback into improvements, supporting eight client onboardings and adoption by Ola, Rebel Foods and BetterHalf.

Product Designer | Parallel HQ

Bengaluru | September 2021 - June 2023

Judges Intelligent Virtual Assistant (Jiva) Case study

Researched judicial workflows and designed an MVP that helps judges search, ask questions and reference case documents during hearings.

Bangalore Pulse Airport App Case study

Contributed to discovery and experience design for Bengaluru International Airport's loyalty app, using modular design and server-driven UI for personalised experiences.

PARALLEL HQ / CONTINUED

Apperture Product Analytics Tool Case study

Designed a 0-to-1 analytics platform spanning query building, data exploration and an embedded AI assistant; defined its visual language and core interactions.

UX Researcher | Kritsnam Technologies

Hyderabad (Remote) | July - August 2021

Conducted competitor analysis, ecosystem mapping, interviews and surveys for the Dhara B2B SaaS dashboard, identifying target user groups and informing product recommendations.

SKILLS

Product design User research, information architecture, interaction design, prototyping, design systems, end-to-end workflow design

Product ownership Discovery, roadmapping, customer collaboration, cross-functional delivery

AI & implementation AI-assisted prototyping, multilingual conversation design, prompt design and evaluation, API integrations, workflow automation

Communication Product storytelling, presentations, public speaking, workshop facilitation

TOOLS

Figma | Claude Code | Claude | ChatGPT | Lovable | Google Cloud Platform | n8n | Storybook | Mixpanel | Grafana | Metabase | Framer | Excel | Adobe Creative Suite

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design | National Institute of Fashion Technology, Gandhinagar

2017-2021 | 9.0 CGPA

Awarded Best Academic Performance and Most Meritorious Student.

SPEAKING & WORKSHOPS

The India AI Impact Summit 2026
Speaker | Using Conversational AI to Spot Attrition Signals | Watch talk

EkStep Voice AI Conference
Speaker | From App Drop-offs to Conversational Onboarding | Watch talk

Scaler School of Technology
Guest lecturer | Designing with Empathy

NIFT, Gandhinagar
Guest lecturer | Storytelling in Case Studies; Basics of UX Design

DESIGN AWARDS

Titan Design Award
2020 - Habit-forming smart wearable ring
2019 - Posture-correcting smart jewellery